BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #16 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I'm old and useless."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Retirement, slower pace, and a culture that prizes youth can make older adults feel invisible. Loss of work, driving, or strength adds to the sense of being no longer needed.

What Scripture teaches

"In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14). "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness" (Proverbs 16:31). "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray." Anna served God day and night in the temple in her eighties (Luke 2:36–37). Paul told Titus that older men and women are to teach others (Titus 2). Older believers hold wisdom and prayer that the church needs.

> *"In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain"* (Psalm 92:14).

Also see

> "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness" (Proverbs 16:31).

> "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you" (Isaiah 46:4).

> "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come" (Psalm 71:18).

> "Older men are to be temperate, dignified, self-controlled, and sound in faith, love, and perseverance. Older women, likewise, are to be reverent in their behavior, not slanderers or addicted to much wine, but teachers of good" (Titus 2:2–3).

Common self-statements

- Nobody needs me.
- I have nothing left to give.
- Young people do not care what I think.
- I am in the way.
- I am past my usefulness.
- My time is over.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either productive or useless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will need me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling overlooked and concluding that I am useless.
- Labeling: Calling myself useless.

Challenging questions

- What do I know and have lived through that others could learn from?
- Who has asked for my advice or prayers?
- What could I give: time, listening, prayer, a skill?

- What does Scripture say about the elderly?
- Who in my life is lonely and might welcome a call?
- What is one way to serve this week?

Truth summary

> God still uses me. My years are a crown, and my wisdom and prayers matter. I can bear fruit at every age, in ways large and small.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Fruitful
- Thankful
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm old and useless"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm old and useless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I know and have lived through that others could learn from?
- ☐ Who has asked for my advice or prayers?
- ☐ What could I give: time, listening, prayer, a skill?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the elderly?
- ☐ Who in my life is lonely and might welcome a call?
- ☐ What is one way to serve this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I still bear fruit in old age.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown.
- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ My wisdom matters.
- ☐ I can pray for others.
- ☐ I am not useless.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 92:14**
  "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain."
- ☐ **Proverbs 16:31**
  "Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness."
- ☐ **Isaiah 46:4**
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still fruitful: Each week, note one way you encouraged or helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 92:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will still bear fruit in old age.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List what you offer. Write skills, stories, and wisdom.
- [ ] Call someone. Reach out to a person who may be lonely.
- [ ] Pray daily. Pray by name for family and friends.
- [ ] Mentor. Offer to share your experience with someone younger.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm old and useless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still fruitful
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm old and useless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You have promised to carry me in old age. Show me how to serve and bear fruit in this season. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #17 · AGING AND DECLINE

"My best years are behind me."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Nostalgia is natural, but it can harden into believing that the good is over. Losses of health, spouse, or work make the past glow and the future dim.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon cautions that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10), and says God "has made everything beautiful in its time" (Ecclesiastes 3:11). Paul, near the end of life, wrote, "Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, I press on toward the goal." Jeremiah's lament says of the LORD's mercies, "They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" Gratitude for the past and anticipation for what God still has can live together.

> *"Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead"* (Philippians 3:13).

Also see

> "He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men, yet they cannot fathom the work that God has done from beginning to end" (Ecclesiastes 3:11).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert" (Isaiah 43:19).

> "So teach us to number our days, that we may present a heart of wisdom" (Psalm 90:12).

Common self-statements

- The good times are gone.
- Nothing will compare.
- I peaked long ago.
- The future has nothing for me.
- Everything was better then.
- I just wait for the end.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing the past was all good and the present is all bad.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that nothing good lies ahead.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling nostalgic and concluding the best is gone.
- Labeling: Calling myself past my prime.

Challenging questions

- What made those years so good, and can any of it be found now?
- What good things am I experiencing today?

- What new thing could I try?
- What does God say about new mercies?
- What do I look forward to?
- Whom might I bless with my experience?

Truth summary

> I can thank God for the past and still look for His goodness today. God makes things beautiful in their time, and His mercies are new each morning.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Thankful
- Joy
- Hopeless
- Dissatisfaction

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My best years are behind me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My best years are behind me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What made those years so good, and can any of it be found now?
- ☐ What good things am I experiencing today?
- ☐ What new thing could I try?
- ☐ What does God say about new mercies?
- ☐ What do I look forward to?
- ☐ Whom might I bless with my experience?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God made everything beautiful in its time.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ I press on toward what is ahead.
- ☐ God does new things.
- ☐ Gratitude honors the past.
- ☐ Today holds gifts.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 3:13**
  "Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 3:11**
  "He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men, yet they cannot fathom the work that God has done from beginning to end."
- ☐ **Lamentations 3:22–23**
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ New mercies: Each day, name one good thing about today.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Philippians 3:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His mercies are new every morning.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Gratitude list. Write the blessings of the past with thanks.
- ☐ Try something new. Take a class, visit a place, or meet someone.
- ☐ Tell your stories. Share them with a grandchild or friend.
- ☐ Read Lamentations 3:22–23. Receive today's mercy.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My best years are behind me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	New mercies
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My best years are behind me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I treasure the past, but let me not miss today. Open my eyes to the good You are doing now and give me hope for what lies ahead. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #18 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I've lost my purpose."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When career, children at home, or health-related roles change, the schedule and the sense of mission change too. Without clear tasks, days feel empty and the question "What am I for?" arises.

What Scripture teaches

"The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me" (Psalm 138:8). "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus." Jesus said, "Love the Lord your God… and love your neighbor as yourself." Those two purposes do not retire. Paul says we are God's workmanship "created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life." Purpose is not only a job title. It is loving God and others in whatever season.

> *"The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever—do not abandon the works of Your hands"* (Psalm 138:8).

Also see

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life" (Ephesians 2:10).

> "Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind and with all your strength.' The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these" (Mark 12:30–31).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

Common self-statements

- I have no reason to get up.
- What am I for now?
- No one needs me.
- My work is done.
- I am just waiting.
- I have nothing to live for.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing purpose is either a career or nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always feel empty.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling aimless and concluding that I have no purpose.
- Labeling: Calling myself purposeless.

Challenging questions

- What roles have I lost, and what have I gained?

- What are the two great commands, and how can I live them today?
- Who is near me who could use a kind word, a meal, or a prayer?
- What skills or interests have I set aside?
- What did I love as a child or young adult?
- What is one thing to do this week that matters to someone?

Truth summary

> My purpose is bigger than a job or role. God's purposes for me continue, and I can love Him and my neighbor in this season. He will complete what He began in me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Elderly
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Guidance
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I've lost my purpose"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I've lost my purpose." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What roles have I lost, and what have I gained?
- ☐ What are the two great commands, and how can I live them today?
- ☐ Who is near me who could use a kind word, a meal, or a prayer?
- ☐ What skills or interests have I set aside?
- ☐ What did I love as a child or young adult?
- ☐ What is one thing to do this week that matters to someone?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.
- ☐ He will complete His work in me.
- ☐ I was made for good works.
- ☐ I can love God and neighbor.
- ☐ Each day has purpose.
- ☐ God is not finished with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 138:8**
  "The LORD will fulfill His purpose for me. O LORD, Your loving devotion endures forever— do not abandon the works of Your hands."
- ☐ **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **Ephesians 2:10**
  "For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance as our way of life."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Purpose today: Each week, note one act of love for God or neighbor.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 138:8 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord will fulfill His purpose for me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your roles. Write the old and new ones.
- [ ] Serve one person. Meet a need near you.
- [ ] Revisit a passion. Pick up an old interest.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 138:8. Ask God to show your purpose.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I've lost my purpose": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Purpose today
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I've lost my purpose.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You will fulfill Your purpose for me. Show me how to love You and my neighbor in this season, and use me today. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #19 · AGING AND DECLINE

"I'm too old to change."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Habits and beliefs become comfortable over decades, and many hear "you can't teach an old dog new tricks." The result is resignation about patterns, health, relationships, or faith.

What Scripture teaches

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind." "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation." Paul said, "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." Caleb at 85 asked for a mountain (Joshua 14:10–12). Moses was 80 when God called him. Sarah and Abraham were old when God worked wonders. No one is too old for God to renew a heart or a habit.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day"* (2 Corinthians 4:16).

Also see

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you" (Isaiah 46:4).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

Common self-statements

- I have always been this way.
- It is too late for me.
- Change is for young people.
- I cannot learn new things.
- People my age do not change.
- Why bother?

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either change when young or never.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I cannot change.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling set and concluding that I cannot.
- Labeling: Calling myself too old.

Challenging questions

- What change do I want most?
- Have I ever changed something after age fifty or sixty?

- Whom do I know who changed late in life?
- What does Scripture say about God renewing us?
- What is the smallest step I could take?
- Who could support me in this change?

Truth summary

> Age does not limit God's power to renew me. I can learn, grow, and change with small steps and His help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Healthy
- Elderly
- Faith
- Wisdom
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Do It Again — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's repeated gifts and new mercies express His continuing love.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm too old to change"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm too old to change." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What change do I want most?
- ☐ Have I ever changed something after age fifty or sixty?
- ☐ Whom do I know who changed late in life?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God renewing us?
- ☐ What is the smallest step I could take?
- ☐ Who could support me in this change?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ I am a new creation in Christ.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ God works at any age.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ I can learn.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Growing still: Each week, note one thing you tried or learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 4:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "My inner self is being renewed day by day.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Pick one change. Choose a habit, belief, or skill.
- [ ] Take a small step. Do it for one week.
- [ ] Find support. Ask a friend to check in.
- [ ] Read Joshua 14:10–12. Be encouraged by Caleb.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm too old to change": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Growing still
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm too old to change.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You renew me day by day. Give me courage to learn and change, and thank You that it is never too late. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #20 · AGING AND DECLINE

“People are just waiting for me to die.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When family talks about wills, care homes, or logistics, an older adult can hear impatience. Isolation, and the absence of visitors, can seem to confirm it. Some begin to feel like a burden or an inconvenience.

What Scripture teaches

God says, “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4). “Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails” is a prayer God answers. “You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God” (Leviticus 19:32). Honoring the aged is God’s command, and many love you. If you ever feel that life is not worth living, call or text 988 or tell someone now.

> *“Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you”* (Isaiah 46:4).

Also see

> “Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails” (Psalm 71:9).

> “You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God. I am the LORD” (Leviticus 19:32).

> “Gray hair is a crown of glory; it is attained along the path of righteousness” (Proverbs 16:31).

> “A father of the fatherless, and a defender of the widows, is God in His holy habitation. God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:5–6).

Common self-statements

- They want me gone.
- I am in the way.
- No one visits.
- My family is counting the days.
- I am just a problem.
- I do not matter anymore.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either wanted or waiting to die.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one cares.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling lonely and concluding that I am unwanted.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a burden.

Challenging questions

- What have people actually said or done that makes me feel this way?
- Who has shown that they love me?
- Have I told someone how I feel?

- What does God say about my years?
- What could I ask my family for?
- Who could I connect with, like a church friend or neighbor?

Truth summary

> God will carry me to old age and beyond, and He commands respect for the elderly. I matter to Him and to people who love me. I can say what I feel, ask for time together, and reach out for support.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Loneliness
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Hopeless

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People are just waiting for me to die"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People are just waiting for me to die." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have people actually said or done that makes me feel this way?
- ☐ Who has shown that they love me?
- ☐ Have I told someone how I feel?
- ☐ What does God say about my years?
- ☐ What could I ask my family for?
- ☐ Who could I connect with, like a church friend or neighbor?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will carry me.
- ☐ God will not forsake me.
- ☐ The elderly are to be honored.
- ☐ Gray hair is a crown.
- ☐ I can ask for connection.
- ☐ I matter.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 46:4
  "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you."
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  "Do not discard me in my old age; do not forsake me when my strength fails."
- ☐ Leviticus 19:32
  "You are to rise in the presence of the elderly, honor the aged, and fear your God. I am the LORD."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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EVERYONE DOES THESE

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Connected: Each week, note one visit, call, or kind word you received or gave.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 46:4 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will carry me and sustain me in my old age.""
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- ☐ Tell someone. Share how you feel with a family member or friend.
- ☐ Ask for a visit. Request time together.
- ☐ Join a group. Connect with a senior group or church class.
- ☐ If you feel life is not worth living, call or text 988 (U.S.). Tell someone now.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

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_____

What I learned: _____

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People are just waiting for me to die.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear being waited out. You have promised to carry me. Surround me with people who love me, and let me know that I matter. Amen.

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